ascentium

Startup toolkit

United States

Setting up and running an LLC or C corporation in the United States.

Inside: the company at a glance · your first 90 days · the annual compliance calendar · are you an SME? · the documents to gather · how Ascentium helps

Mock toolkit prepared for a concept prototype. Not legal, tax or financial advice.
Information as at November 2026. Verify figures with the relevant authority before relying on them.

1. Your company at a glance

Item	What applies
Entity	Limited liability company (LLC) or C corporation
Formation	With the Secretary of State of your chosen state, often Delaware or Wyoming
Registered agent	Required in every state where you are registered
Federal tax	21% corporate rate for C corporations; LLCs are taxed by election
Tax ID	An Employer Identification Number (EIN) from the IRS
Foreign owners	A foreign-owned single-member LLC files Form 5472 with a pro forma Form 1120 every year

Good to know

Missing Form 5472 carries a US$25,000 penalty per form, even for a company with no income.

2. Your first 90 days

Tick these off in order. Your Ascentium dashboard tracks each one and Ascentia will remind you before anything falls due.

- ☐ **Choose the state and entity**
  Delaware suits venture-backed C corporations; Wyoming suits lean LLCs.
- ☐ **File the formation documents**
  Certificate of formation or incorporation.
- ☐ **Obtain an EIN**
  Needed for banking, payroll and tax filings.
- ☐ **Adopt governing documents**
  An operating agreement or by-laws and initial resolutions.
- ☐ **Open a bank account**
  Many banks onboard non-resident founders remotely.
- ☐ **Check sales tax**
  Register in states where you meet nexus thresholds.

3. Annual compliance calendar

The recurring obligations most small private companies meet each year. Exact dates depend on your financial year-end and on notices issued by the authorities.

Obligation	When	Authority
Delaware franchise tax and annual report (corporations)	1 March	Delaware Division of Corporations
Federal corporate return (Form 1120)	15th day of the 4th month after year-end	IRS
Form 5472 (foreign-owned LLCs)	With the pro forma Form 1120	IRS
Delaware LLC annual tax	1 June	Delaware Division of Corporations
State annual reports	Varies by state	Secretary of State

4. Are you an SME?

The SBA sets size standards by industry (NAICS code), using average annual receipts or employee count. Ascentium screens at fewer than 500 employees and under US$40 million in revenue, then confirms against your industry's standard.

Ascentium SME pricing

If your company, assessed together with any linked group companies, meets the official SME definition above, you qualify for Ascentium SME fares and the AI platform. Larger groups are served by Ascentium for Enterprise at ascentium.com.

5. Documents to gather

- ☐ **Passport for every owner and officer**
- ☐ **Proposed company name and state**
- ☐ **Registered agent details**
- ☐ **Ownership and capital structure**
- ☐ **Business address (a registered agent address is acceptable for formation)**

6. How Ascentium helps

AI compliance dashboard	A live compliance score for every entity, with each filing, deadline and document in one view.
Ascentia, AI voice assistant	Ask about your status, deadlines or a change, 24/7, and get a qualified expert when judgement is needed.
Premium Economy fare	Formation, registered agent, EIN, bookkeeping and the federal return from US$1,490 a year.
Switching is easy	Moving from another provider? We take over registers and records and file the change for you.